PERSONAL LEARNING DOCUMENT — SHIVAM KUMAR

ENGLISH B2 FLUENCY ROADMAP

REDESIGNED — ROOT-CAUSE FOCUSED EDITION · UPDATED 9 NOV 2026

Daily Life + Office English | Target: Solid B2 | 100% Free Resources | All Links Tap-Ready

BASELINE	TARGET DATE	DAILY TIME	PROGRESS TEST
EF SET B1 · 41/100	December 2026	1 hour / day	EF SET only

PRACTICE 1HR/DAY

1 The 5-Skill Framework

Skill	What It Means For You	Where It's Practised
Grammar Automaticity	Tense and parts-of-speech recognition and production without conscious translation	Section 2
Expression	Building sentences on the spot without translating from Hindi	Sections 2, 3
Comprehension	Understanding native-speed speech first time, including reduced forms (gonna, wanna, whaddaya)	Section 4
Self-correction	Noticing and fixing your own grammar and word errors	Section 6
Fluency + Confidence	Natural pace, no long pauses, no hesitation	Sections 3, 8

2 Grammar Automaticity — Tense & Parts of Speech

This section comes **first**, ahead of vocabulary, because it is your diagnosed bottleneck. Rule: one video (or one exercise) per day, then use it in Tense-Mapping.

Tag	Resource / Drill	Why It's Here	Access
NEW	**Daily Tense-Mapping Drill**	5 sentences a day — name the tense of every verb out loud	*Self-practice, no link needed*
NEW	**Parts-of-Speech Tagging**	The same 5 sentences — label noun, verb, adjective, adverb, preposition	*Self-practice, no link needed*
BOTH	**Learn ALL Tenses: Complete Course** *English with Lucy*	Full tense course, 20-minute daily chunks	Open Channel →
BOTH	**POC English** *Your trusted channel*	Grammar and tense explanations taught fully in English; the channel that gives you confidence	Open Channel →
BOTH	**Lauren Taylor** *Check once (see note below)*	Clear English explanations of grammar and tense contrasts	Open Channel →
BOTH	**Perfect English Grammar**	Free exercises on spoken sentence patterns — real-time construction	Open Site →
NEW	**English Sentence Structure** *Oxford Online English · 21 min*	Your main need: correct word order so that grammar and sentence come out right together	Find Video →
NEW	**9 Parts of Speech in English** *Oxford Online English · 16 min*	Directly covers your parts-of-speech weak spot	Find Video →
NEW	**Adjectives and Adverbs — 5 Levels of Difficulty** *Oxford Online English · 15 min*	The weaker part of parts of speech, practised level by level	Find Video →

Check once: watch one video of Lauren Taylor. Keep it as a grammar source only if the teaching is fully in English; otherwise English with Lucy's tense course and Perfect English Grammar carry that part. **Oxford:** only the three videos above, not the full 41-lesson course. After each one, reuse its sentences in your Tense-Mapping drill.

3 Active Production — Turning Passive Vocabulary Into Speech

You already know a large passive vocabulary. The gap is retrieval, not storage. These drills force production, not recognition. Start with short, simple sentences ("I went to the market. I bought vegetables."): correct grammar first, longer sentences later.

Tag	Resource / Drill	Why It's Here	Access
BOTH	**Self-talk / narrate your day**	Describe what you are doing out loud in English, 10 minutes a day	*Just practice, no link needed*
NEW	**Chunk Learning (phrase-based)**	Fixed phrases, not single words — locks in correct word order	*Build from your own corrections*
BOTH	**Shadowing**	Play 1 sentence → pause → repeat, matching speed and rhythm → replay to check	*Uses Section 4 resources*

Pronunciation is good-to-have, not the bottleneck. It is checked through your weekly recording review (Section 6).

4 Listening — Native-Speed Comprehension

Tag	Resource	Why It's Here	Access
DAILY LIFE	**Darknet Diaries podcast**	Already in your routine — native, unscripted, natural-speed storytelling	Open Site →
OFFICE	**TED Talks (with subtitles)**	Professional-register native speech; subtitle toggle for self-check	Open Site →
NEW	**English pronunciation: 12 contractions you MUST learn** *POC English*	Fast-speech block 1. Watch once, then shadow its sentences. Check whether it covers reductions like gonna/wanna; contractions alone (I'm, don't) are different.	Find Video →
NEW	**How to use 'wanna' and 'gonna' CORRECTLY** *English with Lucy*	Fast-speech block 2. Lucy is a voice you already follow; this explains the reduced forms.	Find Video →

Why fast speech is hard: native speakers join and shorten words (going to → gonna, want to → wanna, what do you → **whaddaya**, e.g. "Whaddaya want?"). You may know every word and still not hear it. This is a separate skill from vocabulary and it improves with shadowing: 1 sentence, pause, repeat, replay. Where a speaker is too fast or soft, keep subtitles ON. Add new reduced forms to Anki with an English example.

5 Vocabulary — Consolidation Only (De-prioritised)

Vocabulary is secondary — your passive vocabulary is already large. Use it only for genuine gaps. **Playlist Plan Phase 1 (Vocabulary Building) — completed.** Espresso English has been removed from the roadmap.

Tag	Resource	Why It's Here	Access
BOTH	**Anki (free flashcard app)**	Add only a word or chunk you personally got wrong — never generic lists. Use an English example sentence on the back, not Hindi.	Open Site →

6 Self-Correction & Feedback Tools

Tag	Resource	Why It's Here	Access
BOTH	**Grammarly (free tier, browser extension)**	Real-time correction while writing — trains your eye for recurring mistakes	Open Site →
BOTH	**Record yourself weekly + review**	1-minute story, record it, review next day, note 3 recurring mistakes (tense/POS focus). Also your pronunciation check — send the recording to Claude for feedback.	*Built into your Claude practice ritual*

7 Office / Professional English

Unlocks in full once daily-life sentence construction feels stable (December). Sequence still matters.

Tag	Resource	Why It's Here	Access
OFFICE	**Business English Pod (free episodes)**	Real office scenarios — meetings, emails, colleague small talk, phone calls	Open Site →
OFFICE	**engVid — Business English playlist**	Free videos on emails, interviews and presentations from native teachers	Open Site →
OFFICE	**Korten Lesson 1: Master Job Interview Questions** *Professor Korten · December · 24 min*	Direct interview practice; pairs with your STAR mock interviews	Open Channel →
OFFICE	**Korten Lesson 13: Past Modals + Weak Form of 'Have'** *Professor Korten · December · 19 min*	Reduced forms (shoulda, coulda) that match your fast-speech listening problem. Title is cut off in the list; confirm on opening.	Open Channel →
OFFICE	**Korten Lesson 17: Clauses of Contrast & Purpose** *Professor Korten · December · 16 min*	Builds longer, connected interview answers (although, in order to)	Open Channel →
OFFICE	**Complex Sentences in English Writing** *Oxford Online English · December · 15 min*	Longer professional sentences for emails and interview answers	Find Video →
OFFICE	**Your own SOC interview STAR-format practice**	Already in your SOC roadmap — highest-value office English practice	*See SOC_L1_Master_Roadmap_v2.1.pdf*

Only Korten Lessons 1, 13 and 17 are part of this plan. The other lessons of the course are not.

8 Free CEFR Progress-Check — EF SET Only

Resource	What It Gives You	Access
EF SET — 4 skills *90 minutes · baseline, Test 1 and Final Test*	Free CEFR-aligned test of all four skills: speaking, writing, listening and reading, with a personalised EF SET certificate and a full diagnostic	Open Site →

EF SET TEST SCHEDULE
Test 1: 4-skill, 90 min, between 3 Dec and 15 Dec 2026. No tests in October or November.
Final Test: 4-skill, 90 min, exactly 90 days after Test 1 — between 3 Mar and 15 Mar 2027 (same date as Test 1, plus 90 days). This final test is your official, realistic measure of your English, including speaking.
Between tests, progress is tracked by your sharpness rating and weekly recording.
After every test, show your score to Claude for a revised timeline.

9 Final Focus Rules — Locked

1.	This is the complete resource list for your B2 goal — nothing is added without your permission.
2.	B2 is the target. Not C1, not C2 — those solve problems you don't have.
3.	Grammar automaticity (tense + parts of speech) comes first — it is your diagnosed root cause, not vocabulary.
4.	Self-talk and shadowing are your highest-leverage daily practices — never skip them.
5.	Only add a word or chunk to Anki if you personally made a mistake with it — no generic memorising.
6.	Office English (Section 7) starts in full only after daily-life fluency feels stable.
7.	EF SET only — Test 1 (4-skill, 90 min) between 3–15 Dec 2026; Final Test exactly 90 days later (3–15 Mar 2027). No tests in Oct/Nov.
8.	1 hour every day beats a long weekend session — same principle as your SOC roadmap.
9.	One video (or one chunk) per day in the core phases — no binge-watching several videos in one sitting.
10.	Cybersecurity/tech videos (Wireshark, Git, Java, etc.) stay in the separate SOC study slot — don't mix them into this English time.
11.	After every practice session, ask Claude for a sharpness rating, a progress update and a revised timeline.
12.	New words: learn the English meaning with an English example sentence — avoid Hindi translation, so your brain stops translating.